

Parks Board Meeting, August 18, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iNmLJ8BUJT4
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Muny Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, August 18, 2025

Body: Muny Parks and Recreation Board

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer at [00:00:07](#). The presiding officer opened the meeting by leading those present in the Pledge of Allegiance. Leslie was introduced as the new administrative assistant at the corporate office, attending her first official meeting.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Ashley, Brad, Mark, and Shannon (noted via roll call at [00:01:00–00:01:08](#)).
 - **Members Absent:** Not explicitly stated.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified through context and moderation of the board.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance ([00:00:11](#)).

- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:01:37 The board reviewed the June meeting minutes. A motion was made and seconded to approve the minutes. **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Superintendent Report & Storm Recovery Updates

- 00:01:47 **Presenter:** Superintendent Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Malone reported on extensive park recovery efforts following severe recent storms and flooding. Key impacts include:
 - **McCullough Park:** Playground mulch and underlayment severely washed out; cabin 6 and cabin 3 suffered roof damage and water leaks impacting rental revenue; small basketball court goals/backboards were repaired following a fallen tree; generators and equipment in shelters were flooded.
 - **Westside Park:** Merry-go-round safety bars were successfully manufactured and installed by maintenance staff (Travis and Chris). Public works (led by Adam) will soon begin playground and basketball court renovations.
 - **Allshshire Park:** A new shelter was installed; playground mulch is scheduled for delivery on August 24 and will be laid in-house. Basketball court renovation is deferred to 2027.
 - **Riverview Carver Drive:** A baby swing was stolen from the play zone. Shelter concrete requires a 2-inch extension to be completed in-house this fall/spring.
 - **Heekin Park:** Significant ground damage occurring due to unauthorized vehicles parking on the grass along 9th Street (between Hackley and Grant). Orange fencing has been put up temporarily; code enforcement will be consulted. Restroom door frameworks were repaired, but vandalism continues to be a major issue (e.g., destroyed restrooms, ripped-off changing stations).
 - **Thomas Park:** Basketball court and overall renovation pushed to 2027. Softball diamond upgrades have begun, though restrooms were recently vandalized shortly after reopening.
 - **Gamebridge/Lafley Field Partnership:** Discussions are underway with school athletic directors (four “yeses” so far) and Ball Academy/Ball State to host Friday night high school baseball games during the spring season to showcase the facility.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.
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Event & Equipment Rental Approvals

- 00:02:12 **Item Identifier & Title:** Steve Ogle - Swimming Area Free Concert Request
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone / Leslie.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Request to host a memorial free concert (approx. 150 attendees) at the Prairie Creek beach/swim area on September 6 from 12:00 PM to 10:00 PM, featuring a stage rental and a food truck (Neighborhood Pizza vendor). Security is planned to be provided by the applicant.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Board member Mark abstained).
- **00:25:08 Item Identifier & Title:** Parks Department In-House Community Family Event at Heekin Park
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a parks-led community family event with music, games, and bouncy houses at Heekin Park on September 12. Security provided by Legacy Security Company. (Cancelled June events are being rescheduled).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Procedurally noted as an in-house parks event; no formal board vote required, acknowledged with board support.
- **00:27:51 Item Identifier & Title:** Ball State Community Welcome Event Equipment Rental
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone / Shannon.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for bleachers and stage equipment delivery to the village area for a Ball State community welcome walking event on Friday, August 28.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:30:40 Item Identifier & Title:** Southside Neighborhood Association Family Fun Day
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shannon / Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request by Aaron Smith (Southside Neighborhood Association) to use McCullough Park on Tuesday, August 25, from 4:30 PM to 8:30 PM for roughly 100 attendees, with neighbors bringing food and requesting park restrooms to be unlocked.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:32:10 Item Identifier & Title:** Progress Rail Employee Softball Game Request at Gamebridge/Lafley Field
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request by Progress Rail for employee softball games (25–45 participants). Considerable board discussion and concern arose regarding the requested time frame (listed as 5:00 PM to 3:00 AM) and lack of established rental fee structures, insurance policies, and closing procedures for Gamebridge Field.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled / Deferred. Staff directed to follow up with the organization for clarification (suspected typo on hours), establish proper fee

structures, review insurance requirements with the city carrier, and require staff oversight for initial use.

- **00:42:22 Item Identifier & Title:** My Outreach / Canon Commons Pride Festival Equipment Rental
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for equipment rental (one 20x30 tent, six tables, sixty chairs, and three 20x30 canopy tents) for a Pride Festival event at Canon Commons on September 12. Board clarified that Canon Commons events are managed externally (downtown development/city), but parks manage equipment rentals subject to availability.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote. *(Note: Following this item, the board agreed that standard equipment-only rentals paid at the standard fee no longer need to come before the board for individual approval unless a fee waiver is requested.)*
 - **00:47:39 Item Identifier & Title:** East Central Neighborhood Association Old Washington Street Festival Equipment Rental
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for annual equipment support (tents, tables, chairs) for the Old Washington Street Festival (drop-off September 18, return September 21).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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Prairie Creek Reservoir Report & Updates

- **00:50:29 Presenter:** Taylor Beard (accompanied by Grace).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Storm & Flood Impacts:** All wooden piers are currently underwater and require major repairs. Five floating piers snapped and floated away (temporarily secured). Upwards of 15 bent metal poles are stuck underwater, creating a severe hazard for boaters.
 - **Boating & Office Status:** Boating is strongly discouraged until underwater poles can be removed via crane truck (anticipated late week or early next week). The boat launch remains open, though courtesy piers are submerged and damaged. The main office AC unit was heavily damaged by power outages and requires a full rebuild (estimated quotes around \$8,000).
 - **Operations:** Mowing and weed trimming have resumed where water permits. The beach and windsurf beach remain closed due to high water and debris. Staff is

mapping displaced boats and coordinating with leaseholders.

- **Item-Specific Public Input / Technical Assistance:** A local citizen/stakeholder interjected during public comment (02:02:38) offering technical assistance, sub-assembly sharing, and advice on managing boat dock repairs and minimizing wake damage.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.
- **01:13:54 Item Identifier & Title:** Bob Thomas Dealership Annual Company Picnic
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grace.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to rent two beach shelters on Sunday, October 4, for 150–175 people, featuring catering, an outside rental tent, and a bouncy house (A1). Trash cans and open restrooms requested.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:15:16 Item Identifier & Title:** Prairie Creek Informational & Program Proposals (Grace)
 - **Dock Numbering System:** A simplified dock numbering system for next year (Wooden docks: W1–W287; Floating docks: F1, sections A–Z) to reduce confusion.
 - **Pilates in the Park:** Proposed free fitness class on the first Monday of every month (May–October) in partnership with YMCA and Corner Market, featuring a volunteer coffee truck (Blue Boots). Trial run proposed for September 14.
 - **Fall Festival:** Proposed community event (late October: Oct 23 or 30) at the airplane field featuring a corn maze, bouncy house, face painting, haunted trail, hay rides, and local cider/donut sales.
 - **VIP Ron Bonham Day:** Proposal for next year to retain free community festival access while monetizing the old restaurant space upstairs for premium parking, firework viewing, and catering/bartending tickets.

Old & New Business

- **Old Business:**
 - **Tui Pool:** Approaching its final week of operation, closing on Labor Day (September 6).
 - **Flatland Resources / Titson Pond:** Project inspection showed minimal flood damage; completion targeted for early-to-mid next year. Flatland will present a full update at the next meeting.
 - **5-Year Master Plan:** Initial committee of 8–9 members selected (working with Carl, the mayor, and Adam); initial park inventories underway by REA.
- **New Business:**

- **01:23:59 Riverside Normal City Neighborhood Association Wayfinding Signs:** Beth Mesner presented a proposal for the association to fund and install two historical wayfinding signs (aluminum with black powder coat, 36" wide, ~6–7 ft total height) at Tui Park and Emerson Dog Park. The board praised the project, noting historical vetting through the library and historical society must be completed and reviewed by legal before final approval. **Disposition:** Continued to the September meeting.
- **01:36:56 All-City Pickleball Tournament:** Carl Malone and Shannon outlined plans for an upcoming city pickleball tournament on September 26–27 across five locations (including Heekin, store, and Northwest Y as a rain backup), partnering with First Serve (Jenny Morgan and John Rodriguez). Contracts are currently under legal review. **Disposition:** Acknowledged by the board; proceeding pending contract finalization.
- **01:40:54 Budget Discussion:** General board discussion regarding upcoming budget needs, capital equipment lines (specifically lawn mowers), breaking out mulch into a dedicated line item, and tracking storm recovery expenses.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:46:33 Speaker:** Carl Malone (Superintendent) spoke again during public comment to address ongoing resident parking violations on the grass along 9th Street adjacent to Heekin Park, noting that staff has installed orange fencing, posted signs, and will coordinate with code enforcement and the Southside Neighborhood Association to address the property damage.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Next regular meeting scheduled for September (exact date indicated for follow-ups).
- **Adjournment:** A motion and second were made to adjourn the meeting. **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote at **01:51:56**.